

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 10

♥ 10 9

♦ 7 4 3

♣ K 10 7 2

♠ 8 6 5 3

♥ K 5 4

♦ K J 10 8 5

♣ Q



♠ A 9 2

♥ J 7 3

♦ A 9 2

♣ J 9 6 5

♠ 7 4

♥ A Q 8 6 2

♦ Q 6

♣ A 8 4 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South
dummy's ♥K.

Some pretty aggressive bidding gets you to a challenging game. South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♠K, overtaken by East's ♠A. East returns a ♠ to West's ♠10, and he then plays the ♠Q.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 6

With 2 tricks already gone you still have 4 losers. You could consider ruffing the 3 ♣ losers in dummy but that would just create a trump loser even when trumps are splitting 3-2. So it looks like you will have to establish the ♦ suit for discards. You could pull trumps and then play your ♦Q, hoping the defenders will grab their ♦A immediately. But unless they are real novices they will hold it up one round and you'll no longer be able to reach dummy.

The solution is to establish the ♦s before you use up

Ruff the third ♠, then play ♦Q, (which they will duck), and another ♦, (which they will probably take). Win whatever they return, pull trumps ending in dummy, and enjoy your 3 ♦ winners.

If East does not take the second ♦ you continue the suit, and whether you ruff or discard a loser you still make the contract.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 8 6
♥ 9 6 3
♦ Q 7 2
♣ J 9 2

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q 10 5 4

♦ 9 4

♣ 8 6 3

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W		E
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♠ 4 3 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ K J 5

♣ Q 10 7 4

♠ A 7 5

♥ J 7

♦ A 10 8 6 3

♣ A K 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

Suppose you allow dummy's ♠9 to hold the first trick, then start on ♥s. East will hold up the ♥A for 1 or 2 rounds. When he does win it he will return a ♠ and whether you play the ♠A or a low ♠ West will be able to prevent you from reaching dummy.

But if you win the first trick with the ♠A, then dummy's ♠ Q J will provide a guaranteed entry to the good ♥s.

North's 3♦ bid was a transfer to ♥s, and his 2NT bid showed exactly 5 ♥s with an invitational strength hand. South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠6, you play dummy's ♠9 and East contributes the ♠2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 5

The math is easy - you need 4 ♥ tricks. And you should be able to manage that by driving out the ♥A. But the defenders will probably hold up one or two rounds when you play on ♥s, so you must have an outside entry to dummy.

The ♠ Q J will provide that entry **IF** you make sure to win the first trick with your ♠A as an unblocking move. If you don't do so then West will be able to keep you out of the dummy and away from those good ♥s.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 2

♥ K 6 4

♦ 10 8 2

♣ Q 6 3

♠ K J 4

♥ Q J 10 5 3

♦ 7 5 4

♣ 8 2



♠ 8 6 3

♥ A 8 2

♦ Q J 9

♣ J 10 7 4

♠ A 10 5

♥ 9 7

♦ A K 6 3

♣ A K 9 5

West

Pass

Pass

Pass

All Pass

3NT by South

North

Pass

1 ♥

3NT

East

Pass

Pass

South

1 ♦

2NT

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠ 2, you play dummy's ♠ 4 and East plays the ♠ 8.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=2 Total = 7

Needing just two more winners it looks straightforward to establish dummy's ♥ suit.

Suppose you win the ♠ 10 and play the ♥ 9. If the defenders win this trick you are home free. You win their ♠ return with your ♠ A, then continue ♥s to drive out their last stopper while you still have the ♠ K as a dummy entry.

This won't work against good defenders, who will hold up on the first ♥ trick and win the second. Then when they continue ♠s you won't have another ♥ to return to dummy, so while you can use the ♠ K as an entry to establish the ♥s you will never get back to use the good ones.

Instead you should win the first trick with your ♠ A. Now when you attack ♥s a defensive holdup won't hurt you because you have **TWO** ♠ entries, the ♠ J by a finesse and the ♠ K.

West is almost certain to hold the ♠ Q because his ♠ 2 opening lead promises an honor and the ♠ Q is the only one you don't have.

So the ♠ finesse is an odds-on play to get a second dummy entry.